

What a friend we have in Jesus

Text: Joseph M. Scriven, 1855, alt.

Music: Charles C. Converse, 1868

CONVERSE 87.87 D

The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in 4/4 time, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody is primarily in the soprano part, with harmonization in the other parts. The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. Chord symbols (F, Bb, C, C7) are placed above the treble staff at the beginning of each system. The lyrics are written below the vocal staves, with three verses of text provided for each system. The first system includes a first line of lyrics for each voice part. The second system continues the lyrics. The third system includes a second line of lyrics. The fourth system concludes the piece with a final line of lyrics and a double bar line.

1 What a friend we have in Je - sus, all our sins and griefs to bear!
2 Have we tri - als and temp - ta - tions? Is there trou - ble an - y - where?
3 Are we weak and heav - y la - den, 'cum - bered with a load of care?

What a priv - i - lege to car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
We should nev - er be dis - cour - aged - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Pre - cious Sav - ior, still our ref - uge, take it to the Lord in prayer!

Oh, what peace we of - ten for - feit, oh, what need - less pain we bear,
Can we find a friend so faith - ful, who will all our sor - rows share?
Do thy friends de - spise, for - sake thee? Take it to the Lord in prayer!

all be - cause we do not car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
Je - sus knows our ev - 'ry weak - ness - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Je - sus' arms will take and shield thee - thou wilt find a sol - ace there.